

An 11-Game Run, and a Reality Check

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Executive Summary

Atlanta has spent most of this season bouncing between two familiar tiers: genuinely interesting and overtly frustrating. That's what made their recent 11-0 stretch stand out. The Hawks put together their most convincing run of the year, and it looked different from the flashes they'd shown earlier.

It lasted long enough to matter, and it didn't feel like the same team. Alexander-Walker was scoring at a high level without forcing things, Johnson was driving the offense in multiple ways, and Daniels kept impacting plays on the defensive end. More than anything, it looked like the group clicking at its highest level.

Their recent stretch is one of the best runs the franchise has had in years, not just in results but in how it's looked.

That said, context still matters. The full-season sample still points to volatility, and some of this level is being supported by shotmaking that is unlikely to fully hold. A tougher stretch is coming, and it should give a clearer answer as to how real this version of the Hawks is.

Still, the Hawks' young core has given plenty to be excited about this season and beyond.

Historic Context

Table 1: Longest winning streaks in Hawks franchise history

Rank	Wins	Season	Span
1st	19	2014-15	Dec 27 – Feb 2
2nd	14	1993-94	Nov 16 – Dec 16
3rd	12	1968-69	Dec 8 – Jan 4
T-4th	11	2025-26*	Feb 22 – Present
T-4th	11	1997-98	Oct 31 – Nov 20

* = active streak

It has been over a decade since a Hawks team put together a stretch like this.

League Context

Table 2: Longest winning streaks this season

Rank	Team	Streak	Active
1st	OKC	16	
2nd	DET	13	
T-3rd	SAS	11	
T-3rd	ATL	11	
4th	OKC*	10	*

* = active streak

Across the full season, the Hawks have put together one of the longer runs anyone has had.

Seeding Context

Table 3: Eastern Conference shift during Atlanta's run

Team	Before	Now
DET	42-13	51-19
BOS	36-19	47-23
CLE	36-21	43-27
NYK	36-21	46-25
TOR	33-23	39-30
PHI	30-26	38-32
MIA	31-27	38-32
ORL	29-26	38-31
ATL	27-31	38-32
CHO	26-31	36-34

Atlanta was 27–31 and nearly out of the East play-in picture. Now they're 38–32 and right in the middle of it, part of a tightly packed race for spots outside the play-in. Their run has pushed them up to the 7th seed, just 0.5 games back of 6th and 1.5 back of 5th.

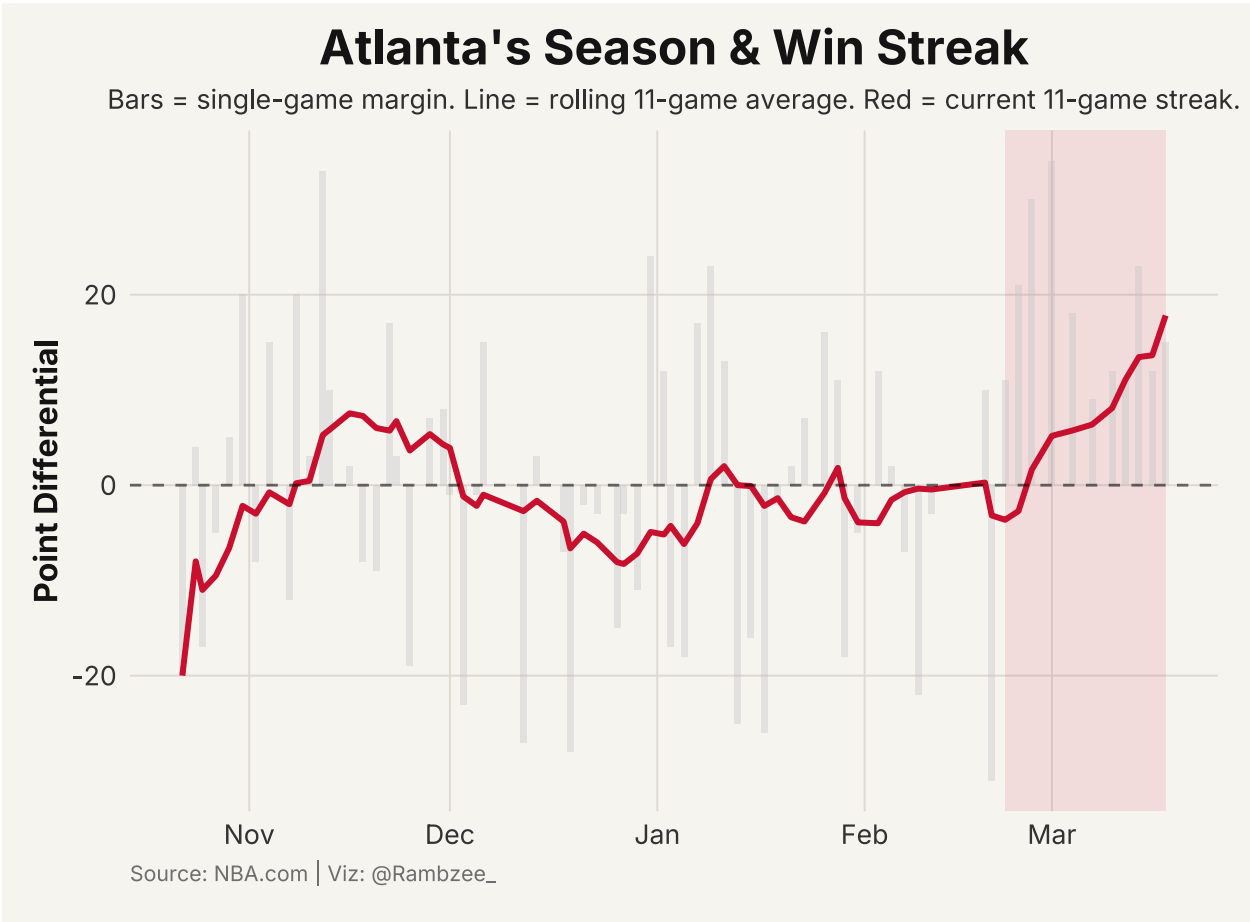
Team Baseline

Table 4: Season vs recent form (team game logs)

window	GP	W	L	PTS	OPPPTS	MOV
First 58	58	27	31	116.9	118.6	-1.6
Last 11	11	11	0	124.0	106.2	17.8
Season	69	38	31	118.1	116.6	1.5

Eleven straight wins does not happen by accident. Atlanta went from being outscored by 1.6 points per game through its first 58 to winning by nearly 18 per game during the streak, all while holding

teams to just 106 a night, well below the roughly 115-point league average.



This is where the season starts to make more sense. Atlanta has had its share of ups and downs, with stretches where things slipped. Lately, though, when they play well, it is not just the offense carrying them. The defense has been good enough to hold things together, which is why these wins have started to stack.

League Context (Last 11 Games)

Table 5: League context over the last 11 games. Relative values are vs league average in the same window.

team_name	GP	W	L	NetRtg	rel_netrtg	netrtg_rank	ORtg	rel_ortg	ortg_rank	DRtg	rel_drtg	drtg_rank
Atlanta Hawks	11	11	0	16.9	+16.7	1	119.9	+6.8	2	103	-9.9	2

Table 6: Top 10 offenses over the last 11 games

Rk	Team	W-L	ORtg	Rel ORtg
1	LAL	10-1	120.0	+6.9
2	ATL	11-0	119.9	+6.8
3	SAS	9-2	119.6	+6.5
4	LAC	6-5	118.9	+5.8
5	NYK	8-3	118.3	+5.2
6	BOS	8-3	117.7	+4.6
7	MIA	7-4	117.4	+4.3
8	CLE	6-5	117.4	+4.3
9	DET	6-5	117.2	+4.1
10	CHA	8-3	116.3	+3.1

Table 7: Top 10 defenses over the last 11 games

Rk	Team	W-L	DRtg	Rel DRtg
1	OKC	10-1	103.0	-9.9
2	ATL	11-0	103.0	-9.9
3	NYK	8-3	106.3	-6.6
4	CHA	8-3	106.9	-6.0
5	POR	6-5	108.0	-4.9
6	BOS	8-3	108.6	-4.3
7	SAS	9-2	108.6	-4.3
8	DET	6-5	109.1	-3.8
9	ORL	7-4	109.7	-3.2
10	LAL	10-1	110.0	-2.9

Table 8: Top 10 net ratings over the last 11 games

Rk	Team	W-L	NetRtg	Rel Net
1	ATL	11-0	16.9	+16.7
2	NYK	8-3	12.0	+11.8
3	SAS	9-2	11.0	+10.7
4	LAL	10-1	10.0	+9.8
5	CHA	8-3	9.4	+9.2
6	BOS	8-3	9.1	+8.9
7	DET	6-5	8.0	+7.8
8	OKC	10-1	8.0	+7.7
9	MIA	7-4	6.4	+6.2
10	LAC	6-5	5.1	+4.8

The offense has been elite, the defense has matched it, and the result is the best net rating in the league over their 11-game stretch.

Process vs Results

The jump did not come from just one area. Atlanta has been shooting better, taking care of the ball, getting to the line more, and forcing more turnovers. The offense has improved, jumping about seven points in offensive rating, but the bigger shift is on the other end. Their defensive rating has dropped

Table 9: Process vs results: which parts of Atlanta's run look sticky and which parts may cool

Window	Overall				Offense			Defense		Efficiency		
	GP	PPG	Opp PPG	MOV	eFG%	TOV%	FTr	Opp eFG%	Opp TOV%	ORtg	DRtg	Net
Season	69	118.1	116.6	1.5	55.1%	13.5%	0.236	54.6%	15.2%	112.6	111.3	1.3
Last 11	11	124.0	106.2	17.8	56.5%	13.1%	0.255	52.8%	16.5%	119.9	103.0	16.9

from 111 to 103, with lower opponent eFG and more forced turnovers. That is where the margin is coming from.

Player Overview (Last 11 Games)

Table 10: Core production over the current 11-game streak

Player	GP	MPG	PTS	REB	AST	STL	BLK	FG%	3P%	FT%	TS%
Dyson Daniels	11	31.5	11.5	7.8	5.8	2.4	0.5	58.4%	12.5%	63.6%	60.0%
Jalen Johnson	11	33.2	20.2	9.6	8.2	1.2	0.3	46.2%	37.0%	76.1%	54.3%
Nickeil Alexander-Walker	11	33.4	22.3	2.7	3.5	1.7	0.3	51.9%	48.3%	97.4%	69.9%
Onyeka Okongwu	11	29.5	13.7	8.5	3.4	1.1	1.5	47.5%	37.5%	72.0%	58.5%

Nickeil Alexander-Walker

Alexander-Walker has played the best basketball of his career over this stretch. The scoring jumps out, but the efficiency is what makes it real. He's around 52% from the field and 48% from three while giving them over 22 a night. Pull-ups, catch-and-shoot, late-clock shots, it's all been there, and none of it feels forced. He's also held up defensively, competing and staying solid on that end even if it's not peak-level impact.

Jalen Johnson

Johnson has been the engine, even if the efficiency hasn't fully followed. He's around 20, 10, and 8, and a lot of what Atlanta is doing runs through him. He grabs and goes, pushes pace, and creates without stalling things out. The shot hasn't always been there, but the impact is.

Dyson Daniels

Daniels is the swing piece. The shooting is rough, there's no way around it, but everything else is high level. He gets downhill, makes the right read, cuts at the right time, and finds ways to finish anyway. More than anything, he creates extra possessions. The steals, the deflections, the disruption, he's everywhere, and it's a big reason this has worked.

Onyeka Okongwu

Okongwu has been a big part of this, and the shooting changes everything. He's turned into a real stretch option, knocking down threes and forcing defenses to account for him. That opens the floor for everything else. He's still giving them around 14 and 8 and holding up defensively. Not an elite rim protector, but solid, even with a heavy workload.

The Core Makes More Sense

The most encouraging part of this run is how cleanly the roles fit. Alexander-Walker provides efficient perimeter scoring, Johnson drives the offense, and Daniels fills in everything else. It's balanced, and it's functional in a way this team hasn't consistently been.

Remaining Concerns

There are still reasons to stay measured. The full season has been uneven, and some of the offense is being boosted by shooting that will not fully hold. The loss in Houston was an early reminder of that. The upcoming stretch should test this version much more seriously, with better teams, tighter games, and less margin for error.

Table 11: Remaining strength of schedule context (Prior to March 20th)

Rank	Team	SOS	Games Left	Toughest Opponents	Easiest Opponents
1	MEM	0.555	14	SAS, BOS, NYK, CLE(2), DEN	UTA, CHI, MIL
2	IND	0.551	12	SAS, DET, LAL, CLE, MIN, ORL	BKN, CHI, WAS
3	NOP	0.548	11	DET, BOS, NYK, CLE, MIN, HOU	SAC, UTA, POR
4	UTA	0.538	12	OKC, LAL, CLE, HOU, DEN, TOR	WAS, NOP, MEM
5	DAL	0.538	12	SAS, LAL, MIN, DEN, PHX, ORL	CHI, MIL, GSW, POR, LAC(2)
6	OKC	0.536	12	DET, BOS, NYK, LAL, DEN, PHX	WAS, UTA, CHI, LAC
7	ATL	0.536	13	DET, BOS(2), NYK(2), CLE, HOU, ORL	BKN, SAC, MEM, GSW
8	BOS	0.535	13	OKC, NYK, MIN, TOR, ORL, ATL(2)	MEM, CHA, MIL

Final Thoughts

It's still March, so this isn't the time to declare anything solved. Some regression is coming, and the full-season sample still matters. But that shouldn't take away from what just happened. Atlanta won 11 straight, went 14–6 over its last 20, and did it in a way that looked different from earlier in the year.

This team has gelled at the right time. The roles are clearer, the production is balanced, and the defense has played at an elite level, supporting the offense instead of relying on it.

The loss in Houston was an early check. Now it gets tested for real. Atlanta has one of the tougher remaining schedules in the league, with multiple games against teams at the top of the East. This next stretch should tell us whether this is just a run or something they can carry forward.

If it holds, the conversation shifts to what this core actually is, and where it can realistically go from here.